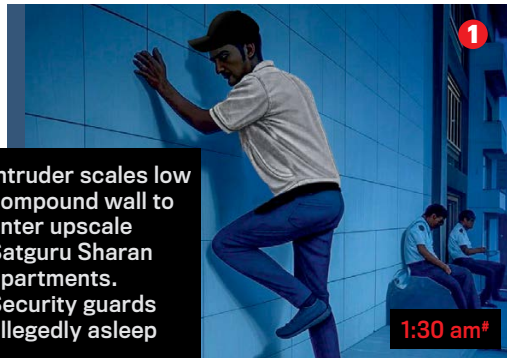
TROUBLING QUESTIONS

In the wee hours of January 16, an intruder breaks into the double-storeyed penthouse apartment of Bollywood stars Saif Ali Khan and his wife Kareena Kapoor in Bandra West. A scuffle ensues, Saif is stabbed, and the robber escapes. After a 3-day manhunt, Mumbai Police announce they have the culprit–an illegal Bangladeshi migrant named Shariful Islam Shehzad Fakir. Except that the police version of events doesn't quite add up...

Graphic by* **NILANJAN DAS | *Text by* **DHAVAL S. KULKARNI**

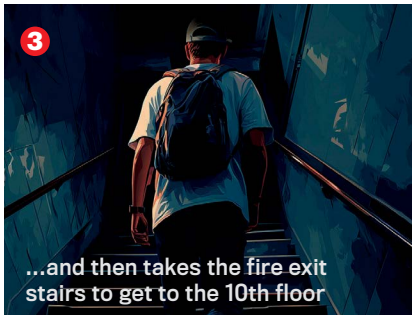
SCENE 1 THE BREAK-IN



Intruder scales low compound wall to enter upscale Satguru Sharan apartments. Security guards allegedly asleep



He climbs a drain pipe to reach the first floor...



...and then takes the fire exit stairs to get to the 10th floor



Uses drain pipe to reach 11th floor, enters Saif's duplex flat after breaking the mesh of the bathroom window

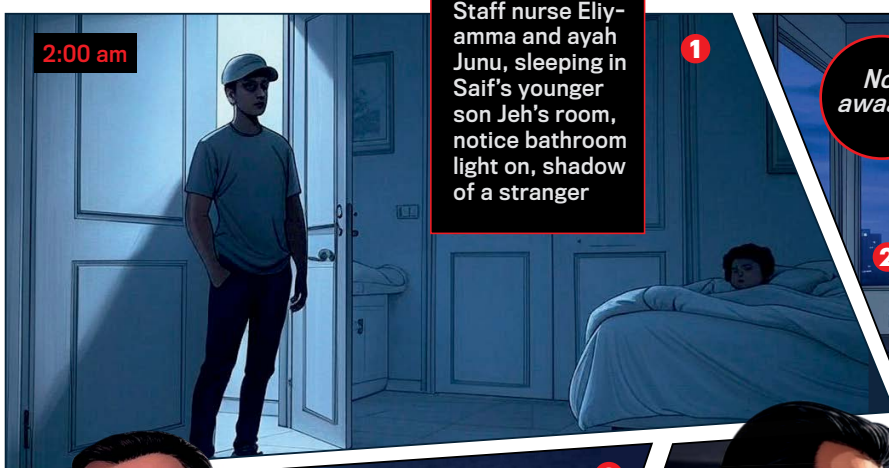
WHAT DOESN'T ADD UP

Q. Why does such a high-end apartment have such poor security and CCTV coverage?

Q. How did the intruder know the layout of Saif's apartment and how to access it? Had he visited it before?

Q. Why did he target the penthouse on the top floors? Wouldn't a flat on a lower floor been easier to rob?

SCENE 2 THE CONFRONTATION



Staff nurse Eliyamma and ayah Junu, sleeping in Saif's younger son Jeh's room, notice bathroom light on, shadow of a stranger



Intruder approaches, signals them to remain quiet. But Junu screams



Saif and Kareena wake up, rush to the room



Saif tries to overpower intruder, who first attacks him with a wooden object, then with a knife